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Group ID: S-J2

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Abstract

This report aims to show the importance of information systems in the tourism industry. The example taken in this report is Travel Box, the main software used by CodeGen company. It is a software platform where bookings and many other features relating to tourism take place. This software has many packages that help people who like to go on tours or vacations. It is powered by artificial intelligence (AI).

Acknowledgments

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1. A brief introduction to the Tourism industry and CodeGen

What is Tourism?

The world's largest and fastest-growing industry is tourism. It provides both income and employment. Additionally, it offers the chance for people to comprehend a nation's culture, civilization, and religious features. (Vedanta, 2022). Tourism is a major source of income for many nations.

There are three basic forms of tourism.

- Domestic tourism refers to activities of a visitor within their country of residence and outside of their home.
- Inbound tourism refers to the activities of a visitor from outside of the country of residence.
- Outbound tourism refers to the activities of a visitor outside of their country of residence. (Visitbritain.org, 2022)

Sri Lanka is a tourist destination. In 1996, the government of Sri Lanka decided to develop tourism in a planned and systematic manner, after identifying the need to set up an instructional framework. (sltda.gov.lk) The government is determined to nurture world-class visitor experience firmly rooted in the inherent natural, cultural, historic, and social capital of Sri Lanka and its people, and ensure that these experiences generate island-wide economic value. Sri Lanka is a beautiful tropical island in the Indian ocean. The industry is poised to offer great growth and investment potential. (investsrilanka.com, 2022) As a result, Sri Lanka has become an increasingly popular destination among international travelers. Sri Lanka has many tourism companies.

CodeGen International (Pvt) is a software company located in Sri Lanka that provides end-to-end software and reservation systems for the global tourism industry. A business with 20 years of expertise in the travel and tourism sector is CodeGen. It is a remarkable technology business that uses innovations to advance society. Travel Box is their most popular travel application. Travel Box offers quick and efficient active distribution over the internet, third-party channels, and more conventional call centers. (codegen.co.uk, 2022)

2. Importance/role of TravelBox in the Tourism industry

Information systems are employed in the tourism sector to make it easier for tourists to find, personalize, and purchase tourism services and goods. It aids in the creation, administration, and distribution of offers to tourists all around the world. Currently, information systems help businesses strategically decide what to do, and tourist destinations can make the most of everything they have by marketing themselves to potential visitors through the use of attractions like museums, architectural landmarks, various cultural and sporting events, festivals, and other events. Information systems are used to increase a company's operations, coordinate functional and business lines, boost the sector's competitiveness and encourage more tourists to visit, like TravelBox.

TravelBox is optimized to manage a wide range of products such as flights, hotels, cars, transfers, activities, tours, insurance, and manual items in multiple booking flow. TravelBox supports multiple sales channels including contact centers B2B and B2C. (codegen.co.uk, 2022) TravelBox is an end-to-end travel technology platform for digital transformation designed to streamline highly technical architectures. As a result, Flight Centre confidently replaced many systems such as Calypso, Switchfly, and Softvoyage GOGO booking engine, making FCTG's operation more efficient and seamless. (codegen.co.uk, 2022) TravelBox is at the heart of FCTG's entire operation. The company is leveraging the full breadth of features and functionalities TravelBox has to offer, from managing supplier profiles, and inventory contracts to pricing and packaging, sales, finance, reporting, and supplier/client documentation. (codegen.co.uk, 2022)

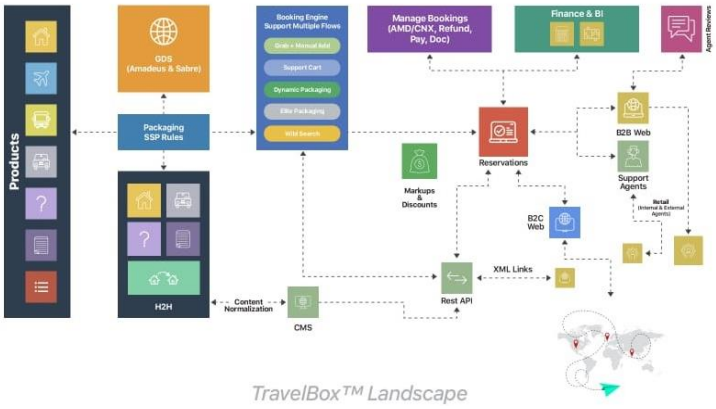


Figure 1: Landscape of TravelBox

The above figure depicts the main landscape of TravelBox aligned to support FCTG's Retail and Wholesale business models.

TravelBox is optimized to manage a wide range of products such as flights, hotels, cars, transfers, activities, tours, insurance, and manual items in multiple booking flow. TravelBox supports multiple sales channels including contact centers B2B and B2C.TravelBox is enabling FCTG to seamlessly manage and automate core operations across six regions on a single instance, as highlighted below. The main goal of information systems is to make decision-making easier and faster. (codegen.co.uk, 2022)



Figure 2: Packages in TravelBox

3. Detailed analysis of TravelBox and how it functions in the organization

TravelBox is a software used by CodeGen which enhances the management of a wide range of products and services such as flights, hotels, cars, transfers, activities, tours, insurance, and manual items in several booking methods. Manage and setting up business rules, global tax requirements, mark-ups, discounts, and cancellations are done under a unified platform. (codegen.co.uk, 2022)

The CodeGen company says that they have different types of TravelBox products that are used by CodeGen in the tourism sector. The way how TravelBox functions in the organization can be seen below. TravelBox platform provides complete booking lifecycle management. TravelBox offers a comprehensive range of third-party connectors including GDS, Channel Managers, hotels, cars, cruises, rail, etc., aggregated across multiple components and inventories to offer the best holiday product in real-time.

This intelligent reservation, retailing, and fulfillment platform can support the most complex business structures and demanding workflows. TravelBox provides fast and effective active distribution via web, mobile, and external channels as well as more traditional call centers. TravelBox is a power-packed travel technology platform delivering an end-to-end solution to maximize sales, conversions, distribution, product, and service optimization significantly. (codegen.co.uk, 2022)

Figure 3: Logo of CodeGen

TravelBox offers an end-to-end product management solution with advanced product loading capabilities, be it static or negotiated contracts to manage any type of product. Users can manage accommodation, flights, rail, cruise, car hires, transfers, insurance, tours, excursions, tickets, activities, etc. Easily manage rates, rules, conditions, discounts, and supplements in real-time and respond to customers effectively. (codegen.co.uk, 2022)



Figure 4: Logo of TravelBox

TravelBox is powered by AI. So, it leverages industry-leading expertise in Artificial Intelligence (AI) for advanced customer journey mapping with TravelBox and delivers data-driven insights to influence the booking behavior of the new-age traveler. Utilizing this Semantic Review Engine, AI Chatbot, Revenue Manager, Personalization, and Recommendation Engine, provide an unmatched customer experience. (codegen.co.uk, 2022)

4. Past, present, and future of TravelBox in CodeGen company

4.1 Past of TravelBox

The CodeGen company was originated in 1999 by Dr. Harsha Subasingha, a senior software engineer and project manager of a specialist IT solutions provider for the travel and tourism industry in Sri Lanka. Codegen was launched with just 5 employees, today Codegen is a Lankan powerhouse with a team of 500.

Having obtained Business Operating Income (BOI) status in 2001, Codegen successfully entered the global market with a proud Sri Lankan identity. TravelBox was launched in 2003 and it is the main software product of the company CodeGen. Since launching the main software TravelBox, Codegen has grown to become a highly sought-after solution provider among top travel agencies, airlines, tour operators, hotels, and numerous other travel-related businesses worldwide.

4.2 Present of TravelBox

TravelBox product achieves this through the interaction of a series of modules - core modules (essential for establishing key operating procedures, system set-up, and administration) and Optional Modules (selected by the client to match the needs of the business). TravelBox Technology allows for a multi-channel distribution model for travel and tourism products, incorporating the unification of multiple online booking websites, multiple call centers or retail outlets, or data loading teams, as well as other interface devices. Tour operator software allows leading travel agencies to run their business efficiently and effectively. It is utilized by a wide array of travel sectors to make successful commercial environments and become more profitable. These systems streamline and boost the value of travel business processes for travel suppliers and each user and deliver a decisive competitive advantage to them. It is one of the most effective systems accessible today for travel services. Most travel agencies like it to access online travel airline inventories, room inventories, air ticket booking, and other value-added services. It processes the very best variety of transactions on a day-to-day basis. Tour Operator software is designed for providing wonderful itinerary tour packages to you by providing air ticket booking, lodge accommodation, and several sightseeing tours. If you have opted for any travel package from some agency, then the company’s agent

would avail all the services for you and you don’t need to find time from your tight schedule to arrange everything. (codegen.co.uk, 2022)

4.3 Future of TravelBox

The tourism industry has countered numerous forces of amendments by taking on a fresh model; accepting innovation led by travelers’ co-creation actions. At one time that was thought of as a problem that could not be handled, now the leaders in the industry identify the brilliance of the plan through many technologies to form new travel products. As we know travel box is one of the technologies that is used in the tourism industry.

We would recommend using the latest tourism technology trends which can be added in the future to make travel box one of the best applications to be used in the tourism industry. The more up-to-date the technology is, the more materials are produced. For example, Cyber security. Many companies in the industry are increasingly at risk from cyber-attacks and are also more vulnerable to data breaches of other kinds. Travel companies are a major target because they employ lots of people and have access to an abundance of customer data.

5. Conclusion

Information systems play an important part in the tourism industry. At this rate, technology will gradually evolve and be more advanced in the future. Thus, it will help in the growth of the tourism industry. TravelBox is among the best software used in the tourism industry among the twenty-three countries in the world. This software is very good and known among most people who go on vacation because of its good services and the experience it provides to its customers, as evidenced by the good reviews given by its customers. This has brought the company a good reputation.

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7. Appendices

7.1 Workload Matrix

Work Done	Student details
• A brief introduction to Tourism Industry and CodeGen. • Acknowledgements.	Student ID: 20221062 Student Name: Nuhansa De Silva
• Detailed Analysis of TravelBox. • References.	Student ID: 20221063 Student Name: Mohamed Adheeb
• How TravelBox functions in the organization. • Cover page. • Abstract. • Appendices.	Student ID: 20221078 Student Name: Umar Jamal
• Importance/role of TravelBox in the Tourism Industry. • Conclusion.	Student ID: 20221080 Student Name: Kajadeeban Vigneswararajah
• Past, present, and future of TravelBox in CodeGen company.	Student ID: 20221083 Student Name: Shevon Kahandawita

7.2 Meeting Agenda and Minutes

Meeting One Agenda

- Date: 02/11/2022
- Work Done:

Time	**Agenda One Description**
3.30pm – 4.00pm	Distribution of the topics.

Meeting Minutes

Time: 3.30pm – 4.00pm

Members attended: Nuhansa De Silva

Mohamed Adheeb

Umar Jamal

Kajadeeban Vigneswararajah

Shevon Kahandawita

Summary: The topics were distributed to the members.

Meeting Two Agenda

- Date: 05/11/2022
- Work Done:

Time	**Agenda Two Description**
12.00pm – 12.30pm	Discussing collected points.

Meeting Minutes

Time: 12.00pm – 12.30pm

Members attended: Nuhansa De Silva

Mohamed Adheeb

Umar Jamal

Kajadeeban Vigneswararajah

Shevon Kahandawita

Summary: The points which were collected were discussed.

Meeting Three Agenda

- Date: /11/2022
- Work Done:

Time	**Agenda Three Description**
1.30pm – 2.00pm	Finalizing the points

Meeting Minutes

Time: 1.30pm – 2.00pm

Members attended: Nuhansa De Silva

Mohamed Adheeb

Umar Jamal

Kajadeeban Vigneswararajah

Shevon Kahandawita

Summary: The points collected were finalized.

Meeting Four Agenda

- Date: 21/11/2022
- Work Done:

Time	**Agenda Four Description**
10.00am – 10.15am	Planning for Presentation.

Meeting Minutes

Time: 10.00am – 10.15am

Members attended: Nuhansa De Silva

Mohamed Adheeb

Umar Jamal

Kajadeeban Vigneswararajah

Shevon Kahandawita

Summary: The topics were divided again to make the presentation.

Meeting Five Agenda

- Date: 22/11/2022
- Work Done:

Time	**Agenda Five Description**
1.30pm – 2.00pm	Completion of the presentation.

Meeting Minutes

Time: 1.30pm – 2.00pm

Members attended: Nuhansa De Silva

Mohamed Adheeb

Umar Jamal

Kajadeeban Vigneswararajah

Shevon Kahandawita

Summary: The presentation slides were finalized, and the presentation was completed.